

Problem 5: Önge (20 marks)

Given below are some sentences in Önge along with their *corresponding* English translations.

Sl. No.	Önge	English
1	<i>mi chogegantitebe tukirikotalotaga</i>	<i>I pierced the fish with all the spears.</i>
2	<i>uemetabetebe</i>	<i>The dog drowned.</i>
3	<i>etia niko angibete belebe</i>	<i>We gave you a matchbox.</i>
4	<i>uemekotalotagatekkebe</i>	<i>All the dogs barked.</i>
5	<i>entoge ngialabukebe</i>	<i>The bachelor scolded you.</i>
6	<i>ueme ogentitebe</i>	<i>The dog pierced the husband.</i>
7	<i>onggege mi entueme belebe</i>	<i>The father gave me the puppy.</i>
8	<i>onggenegatekkebe</i>	<i>The old man barked.</i>
9	<i>allekotalota mialabukebe</i>	<i>All the women scolded me.</i>
10	<i>onggebe onggege choge belebe</i>	<i>The mother gave fish to the father.</i>
11	<i>etakotalota entuementitebe</i>	<i>All of us pierced the young dog.</i>
12	<i>entalle uema uebe chogega</i>	<i>The girl covered the dog with the fish.</i>

Assignment 1:

Translate the following sentences to Önge. If a sentence cannot be formed in Önge from the given data, write “NP” in your Answer Booklet and explain your reasoning.

- All the old women covered the matchbox with the spear.*
- The big dog barked.*
- The unmarried woman gave you the fish.*
- We pierced using all the spears.*
- You all drowned.*

Assignment 2:

Give words in *Önge* for the following:

- | | |
|---------------------|---------------------------------------|
| a. <i>Old Woman</i> | e. <i>Bachelor Man (yet to marry)</i> |
| b. <i>Man</i> | f. <i>Boy</i> |
| c. <i>Woman</i> | g. <i>Mother</i> |
| d. <i>Girl</i> | h. <i>Father</i> |

Önge is a language belonging to the *Andamanese-Ongan* language family, spoken by the Ongan people of South Andaman. It was once a widespread language in the Andaman Islands until the British colonizers arrived. *Önge* is on the verge of extinction: In 1997, it was estimated that there were only 96 native speakers of the language. The surviving speakers are located at Dugong Creek and South Bay in Little Andamans.

- Aalok Sathe
